

ABDULLAH “AJ” AL-JARALLAH

Marketing Science • Bayesian MMM • Applied AI

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PROFILE

Marketing operator turned measurement specialist. Over ten years running \$30M+ marketing portfolios across banking, government, and enterprise tech in the GCC, now finishing my MSBA at UC San Diego with a capstone in Bayesian Marketing Mix Modeling at Direct Avenue. I led Kuwait Finance House's first European campaign, drove 100% digital adoption across 3,000+ employees at Kuwait's social security institution, and run three side ventures in tourism, diving, and growth consulting. I am comfortable both running campaigns and building the agent systems that measure them — my Neural Vault project integrates Claude, Obsidian, and MCP to manage knowledge work end-to-end. Targeting Marketing Science, Measurement, and Applied AI roles across MENA.

MARKETING SCIENCE & APPLIED AI PROJECTS

Direct Avenue (Performance Media Agency, US) Remote / San Diego Mar 2026 – Jun 2026

AI Research & Agent Lead — Bayesian Marketing Mix Modeling Capstone

- Owning industry research, prompt and reasoning design, and the agent / AI research repository for a US performance media agency.
- Built a Bayesian MMM decision-support dashboard in Streamlit and Python, replacing a planned multi-agent system after a scope review with the client and faculty advisors Yiying and Thomas Buyers.
- Delivered a reproducible MMM pipeline, ML model evaluation, and prompt-design protocols now feeding live client decisions on media allocation.

Stack: Python, PyMC, scikit-learn, Streamlit, Claude, MCP, Quarto

Neural Vault — Personal AI Knowledge System San Diego / Kuwait 2024 – Present

Founder, Architect, Maintainer

- Built a two-layer memory architecture combining Claude's native memory with a structured Obsidian wiki, including a Context Injection Protocol, COMMIT flag, auto-save git daemon, and MCP integrations for Obsidian, Notion, Gmail, and Google Calendar.
- Documented the system in a Quarto / HTML guide and presented it to UC San Diego faculty (Prof. Vincent Nijs, MGTA 454, GenAI for Business).
- Shipped core components independently before similar approaches were published elsewhere.

Stack: Claude, MCP servers, Obsidian, Quarto, Python, git

Marketing Campaign ROI Dashboard San Diego Jun 2025

Designer & Developer

- Built a Power BI dashboard analyzing multi-channel campaign performance across digital and traditional media, enabling near-real-time budget reallocation; modeled ROI lift of ~23% under tested allocation scenarios.
- Aggregated campaign data via SQL and automated refresh pipelines in Python.

Stack: Power BI, SQL, Python

Customer Churn Prediction Model San Diego Sep 2025

Modeler — Financial Services Case

- Trained and compared Logistic Regression, Random Forest, and Gradient Boosting models on customer demographics, transactions, and engagement metrics; best model reached 87% accuracy.
- Identified retention drivers and recommended targeted interventions modeled to reduce churn by ~15%.

Stack: Python, scikit-learn, pandas, Tableau

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Public Institution for Social Security (PIFSS) Kuwait City

Dec 2020 – Present

Public Relations Specialist

- Designed and led the digital transformation strategy that drove email adoption from 0% to 100% across 3,000+ employees in three months, tracked across 20+ departments.
- Built the institution's first comprehensive marketing calendar, content guidelines, and measurement framework for internal and external communications.
- Created and launched an internal high-performance recognition program with HR, increasing measurable employee engagement.

Stack: Power BI, Tableau, change management frameworks, content operations

Kuwait Finance House (KFH) Kuwait City

Sep 2017 – Dec 2020

Marketing Analyst

- Managed a \$30M+ annual marketing portfolio across Group Retail Banking, Group Corporate Banking, and Private Banking divisions.
- Pioneered KFH's first-ever European marketing campaign — delivered measurable ROI lift and earned an early promotion.
- Allocated budgets across digital, OOH, print, sponsorships, and events using campaign performance data and post-buy analysis — the operational foundation for my later move into Marketing Mix Modeling.
- Developed segmentation-driven strategies that increased product adoption and customer engagement across multiple banking products.

Stack: Excel, agency reporting, campaign analytics, Adobe Analytics

Xerox — Alghanim Industries Kuwait City

Jun 2016 – Sep 2017

Account Manager

- Generated KD 3M (~\$10M USD) in revenue through tender management, smart workflow solutions, and B2B account expansion.
- Consistently exceeded sales targets by identifying customer needs and delivering tailored proposals.
- Built C-suite relationships across Kuwaiti corporates, ministries, and family offices.

VENTURES

Casa Masira Masirah Island, Oman

2022 – Present

Co-Founder

- Boat charter and adventure tourism business. Run operations, marketing, partnerships, and bookings end-to-end.

Dive36 Diving Center Kuwait

2013 – Present

Co-Founder & PADI Master Instructor

- PADI-certified diving center. 10+ years of instruction, business operations, and marketing.

GrowthIQ Kuwait / GCC

2024 – Present

Founder

- Growth and martech consultancy advising GCC clients on marketing measurement, attribution, and AI integration.

EDUCATION

UC San Diego — Rady School of Management San Diego, CA Expected Jun 2026
MSBA, STEM-designated

- Coursework: Bayesian methods, optimization, classification, uplift modeling, GenAI for Business (Prof. Vincent Nijs, MGTA 454), regression, digital disruption (Prof. Thales Teixeira).

University of Missouri — Kansas City Kansas City, MO 2015
BBA, Marketing Major

- Graduated with Honors. GPA 3.5.

Australian College of Kuwait Kuwait
Diploma in Business Administration, Marketing emphasis

SKILLS

Marketing Science & Measurement: Bayesian Marketing Mix Modeling (MMM), incrementality testing, multi-touch attribution, conversion lift, brand lift, A/B testing, geo-experiments.

Programming & Data: Python (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, PyMC), R, SQL, Power BI, Tableau, Streamlit, Quarto, git.

Applied AI & Agents: Claude, MCP (Model Context Protocol), agent design, prompt engineering, fine-tuning, retrieval, LLM-augmented workflows, Obsidian + Claude integration.

Marketing Operations: Campaign management at \$30M+ scale, digital analytics, performance marketing, agency management, social media strategy, content operations.

Languages: Arabic (native), English (fluent).

CERTIFICATIONS

DataCamp: Machine Learning Fundamentals • Data Manipulation with Python • Statistical Analysis & Modeling • Data Science for Business.

Applied AI: Fine-Tuning Language Models for Business Tasks, Generative AI for Business.

Marketing: Strategic Marketing Planning, Digital Marketing, Social Media Marketing, Innovative Thinking.

Other: PADI Master Instructor.